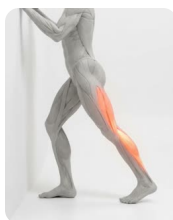




Exercises for feet that hurt from standing

For long shifts on your feet. A printable sheet from walkito.site.

How to use this sheet: start with the easier exercises and the lower dose. Mild discomfort is fine; sharp pain is not. If an exercise makes the pain worse the next morning, drop back a step. The doses are Walkito's starting doses, not a prescription. Full guide with videos and the studies: walkito.site/feet-hurt-standing-all-day



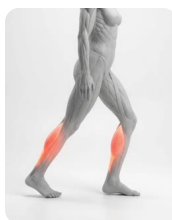
Calf stretch

2 holds of 30 seconds, each leg

Most sessions

Put your hands on a wall. Keep the back leg straight, the heel down and the hips forward. A tight calf pulls on the heel all day, so this stretch targets the single strongest risk factor the 2003 study found.

Evidence: Moderate. The 2023 heel pain guideline grades calf stretching A for plantar fasciitis. A tight calf was the strongest risk factor in a 2003 case-control study.



Soleus stretch

2 holds of 30 seconds, each leg

Most sessions

Take the same wall position, then bend the back knee until you feel the stretch lower down, near the heel. The soleus, the deeper calf muscle, only lets go with the knee bent.

Evidence: Moderate. Same mechanism as the calf stretch: targets ankle flexibility, the strongest risk factor for plantar fasciitis in the 2003 study.



Plantar fascia stretch

2 holds of 30 seconds, each foot

Most sessions

Sit and cross the foot over the other knee. Pull the toes back until you feel the stretch along the arch, not the calf. If your heel is worst first thing in the morning, do this one before your foot touches the floor.

Evidence: Moderate. The 2023 heel pain guideline grades plantar fascia stretching A for plantar fasciitis.



Heel raises, both feet

3 sets of 10, both feet

Strength days

Stand on both feet, rise straight up over the big toes, then lower slowly. Both feet share the load while the calf builds strength. Hold a wall or rail if you need balance.

Evidence: Moderate. The 2023 heel pain guideline grades strength training B for plantar fasciitis. Not tested for standing fatigue specifically.



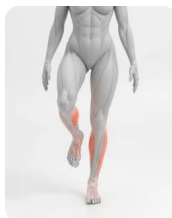
Short foot, seated

3 sets of 10, hold 5 seconds, each foot

Strength days

Sit with your foot flat on the floor. Pull the ball of the foot toward the heel so the arch lifts, and hold. Do not curl the toes. The short foot trains the small muscle inside the arch that holds it up during a long day on your feet.

Evidence: Early. A 2024 review found short-foot training changed arch shape but not pain. In a 2023 trial it was part of a program that improved arch measures.



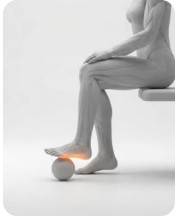
Single-leg hold

3 holds of 30 seconds, each leg

Balance days

Stand on one foot and look at one fixed spot. Let the foot wobble. The wobble is the foot doing the balancing. Stand near a wall if you need a safety net.

Evidence: Early. No standing-specific study. General balance work for the foot and ankle.



Foot roll

2 minutes

Recovery days

Sit and roll the sole of your foot slowly over a massage ball, with firm pressure. If you are wincing, ease off. Rolling after a long shift settles the tissue and brings some relief before the next day.

Evidence: Early. Not tested in the studies on this page. A comfort measure between sessions.

Week log: tick what you did	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Calf stretch							
Soleus stretch							
Plantar fascia stretch							
Heel raises, both feet							
Short foot, seated							
Single-leg hold							
Morning pain (0 to 10)							

See a clinician first if

- the pain followed an injury or a fall
- you cannot put weight on the foot, or you are limping
- it comes with numbness, tingling, burning, swelling or warmth
- the heel or foot is red, or you have a fever or feel unwell
- it wakes you at night
- it is sharp, or getting worse despite easing the load
- pain is localized to one pinpoint spot and worsens with activity, which can be a stress fracture pattern rather than standing fatigue
- one leg or foot has swollen suddenly and is painful, red or warm
- you have diabetes, reduced feeling in your feet or poor circulation
- the pain has not eased after several weeks of lighter load, better footwear and the exercises on this page